A Beginner's Guide to Signing Forms & Releases

Welcome to the Carte Blanche Forms Hub! Signing legal releases might sound like dry paperwork, but we've made the whole process fast, easy, and completely paper-free. Here's everything you need to know in plain English.

> ⭐ **The Golden Rule: Two Signatures Needed!**
>
> A release form is only legally valid once **both** people have signed: the **Contributor** (interviewee or guest) and the **Producer** (you!).
>
> **To save everyone time and energy, our system only emails the final form to release@carteblanche.co.za after everyone has signed.**

Which Way Should You Sign?

IF YOUR SITUATION IS...	USE THIS OPTION	HOW IT WORKS IN PRACTICE
Contributor is not with you (or prefers using their own phone)	METHOD 1 **Share a Link** (WhatsApp, Email, QR)	You send them a link → They sign on their phone → You get an email to review and countersign → Sent to Legal automatically!
Standing with them on shoot	METHOD 2 **Sign Together on One Device**	Open the form on your tablet or phone → Turn on "Producer Present" → Both sign on screen → Done on the spot!
Out in the bush with no signal	METHOD 3 **Offline PDF Backup**	Download a blank PDF before you leave → Sign on an iPad or print it out → Email it when you get back online.

Accessing the Forms Hub

Go to **https://cb-deliverables.web.app/** (the new CARP) and click on the pink card titled **Legal & Production Forms**.

Quick Form Picker:

- **Participant Release** (Interviewees)
- **Minor Release** (Children)
- **Location Agreement** (Venues)
- **Footage Release** (Third-Party Footage)
- **Music Agreement** (Non-Library Music)
- **Insert Sheet** (Straps & Titles / Credits)

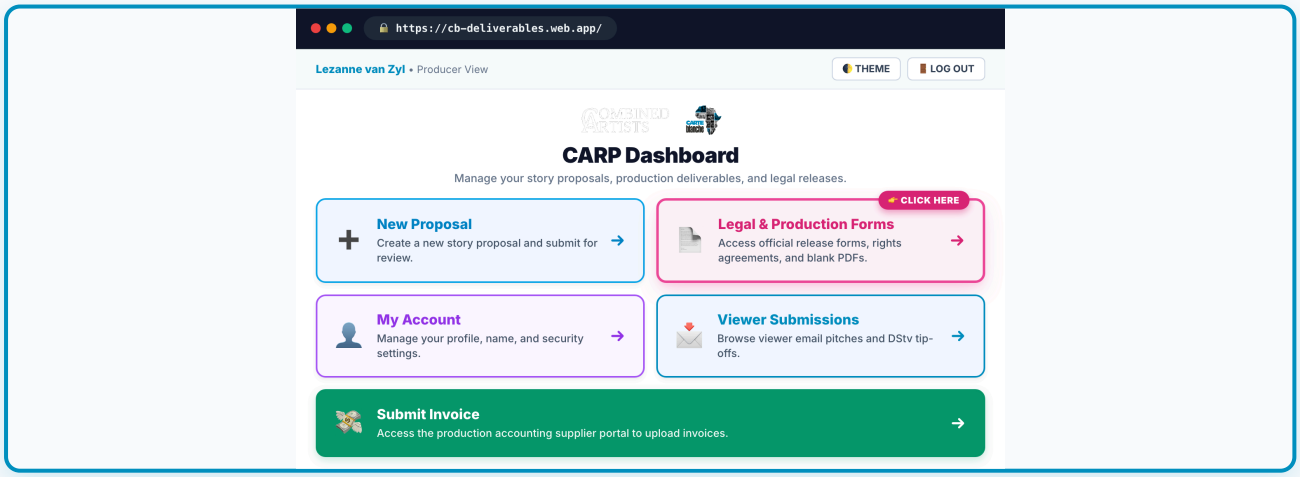


Figure 1: On the CARP Dashboard (https://cb-deliverables.web.app/), click the pink Legal & Production Forms card to open the Forms Hub.

Method 1: Sending a Link to a Contributor (Most Popular)

Use this to easily share a form to be signed with your case study, expert or source. You can share the form as follows:

- WhatsApp the link
- Copy the link to send on platforms other than WhatsApp
- QR Code (for your case study to scan with their phone)
- Email the link

1 Click "Share Online Form with Participant"

On the Forms Hub, find the agreement you need (e.g. *Participant Release Form*). Instead of opening it yourself, click the blue button marked **"Share Online Form with Participant"**.

2 Enter the Shoot Details

A window pops up asking for your story details so your contributor doesn't have to guess them:

- **Story / Project Title:** e.g. *Solar Farm Investigation*
- **Commission Number:** e.g. *2026-CB-042*
- **Producer Name:** Your name
- **Producer Email:** Your email address (crucial — this is where your countersignature notice arrives!)

3 Send It Across

As soon as you type those in, the system generates a tailored link:

- **On WhatsApp:** Click the green **"Share to WhatsApp"** button to send the pre-filled message straight to your contributor.
- **Copy Link:** Click **"Copy Link"** and paste it into an email, SMS, or Telegram chat.
- **QR Code:** Click **"Show QR Code"** if you are standing with them — they can simply point their phone camera at your screen to open the form!

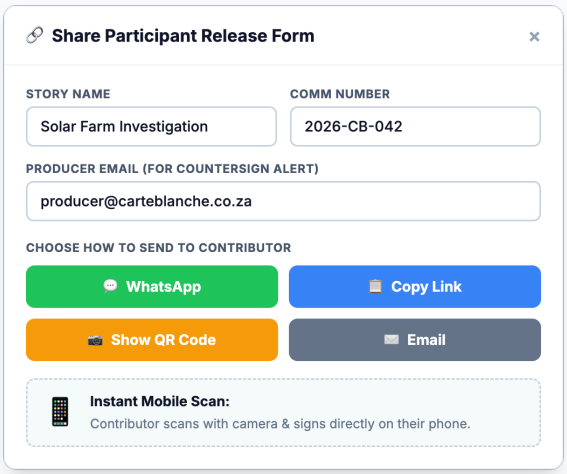


Figure 2: The Share modal creates a pre-populated link ready to send via WhatsApp, email, or instant QR code.

4 You Sign the Final Approval (Countersign)

You will receive an email from **Forms Hub - Carte Blanche** with subject `PLEASE SIGN: [Form Title] – [Comm Nr] – [Story Title]`. Click the **"Review & Countersign Agreement"** button in your email to open the portal:

1. Review the contributor's verified details and digital signature.
2. Draw your signature in the Producer Countersignature box.
3. Tap **"Approve & Submit to Legal"**.



Figure 3: Your one-click review screen showing the contributor's verified submission and your countersignature pad.

Method 2: Signing Together in Person (On Location)

If you're on location with your contributor and have an iPad, tablet, or phone, you can get both signatures done together in under two minutes.

- **Step 1:** On the Forms Hub, click **"Fill Online"**. Fill in the shoot details.
- **Step 2:** Scroll down and switch on **"Producer Present? Sign Together Now"**. Two separate signature boxes appear side-by-side.
- **Step 3:** Hand the phone to the contributor to sign, then sign in your box, and tap **"Sign & Submit Agreement"**.

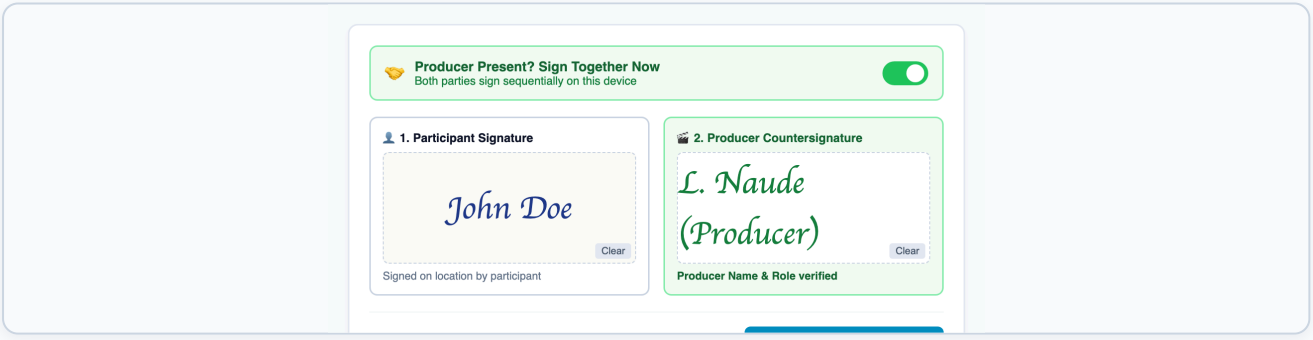


Figure 4: The in-person toggle unlocks side-by-side contributor and producer signature pads on a single device.

Method 3: The Offline Backup (When You Have No Signal)

Headed out to a remote game reserve, a boat at sea, or somewhere where your mobile phone says *No Service*? Don't stress:

1. **Before you leave the office:** Go to the Forms Hub and click **"Blank PDF"** under the agreement you need. This downloads a fillable PDF to your device.
2. **On location:** Open the PDF on an iPad or tablet and have them sign with a stylus / Apple Pencil. Or print paper copies before your trip and sign with a pen.
3. **When you're back in range:** Simply email the signed PDF or a clear photo of the form to `release@carteblanche.co.za`.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if I lose cell reception midway through an interview?
A: The forms work offline once opened in Safari or Chrome! If connection drops, use the downloaded Blank PDF or sign in person as soon as signal returns.

Q: Can the contributor download a copy of what they signed?
A: Yes! Once submitted, the confirmation screen offers an instant PDF download, and a copy is emailed to their provided email address.

Q: Can I forward my countersign email to another producer or researcher?
A: Yes. The review link is secured by an encrypted submission token. Any authorized team member can open the link and countersign on behalf of production.